

**Ohio River Water Trail
Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC)
RFP for Map/Guide Design Services
Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ's)
October 5, 2012**

CONSULTANT HISTORY

1. Has the organization already been working with a professional?

The ORTC has not yet worked with a consulting professional on the development of the water trail. However, the ORTC has worked with professionals related to the development of the Ohio River Land Trail along the Ohio & Beaver Rivers.

DEADLINES

2. The project start date of November 1, 2012 suggests an immediate (and chilly) November river trip. Given the overall project schedule, we do not see an alternative. Please confirm that is the ORTC strategy.

Our goal is to complete the project in time for the 2013 paddling season which will require the bulk of the work to be completed in the winter months. The ORTC understands that this objective is a bit aggressive for a project with this amount of information. The ORTC is flexible with the timeframe and is amenable to extending the project timeline to July 15, 2013 and possibly longer if circumstances require it.

FUNDING PARTNERS

3. What are the specific program sources of funding for this project and do those funding sources have specific requirements that may not be stated in the RFP?

Funding for this ORTC project is provided by the Port of Pittsburgh Commission and a National Park Service's Challenge Cost Share Program (NPS-CCSP) grant.

4. In addition to the PEC funding, is there state or federal funding involved that would require specific MBE/WBE involvement? Are there DBE requirements for this proposal?

The Pennsylvania Environmental Council (PEC) is not a funder of this project. PEC is a partner in this project as the manager of the PA Water Trails Program.

It is the Ohio River Trail Council policy to award a fair share of contracts to small businesses, minority-owned firms, and women's business enterprises. The ORTC is strongly committed to the objectives of this policy will take affirmative steps to ensure such fairness by ensuring procurement procedures are carried out in accordance with 43 CFR § 12.944 (OMB Circular A-110) Uniform Administrative Requirements for Grants and Agreements with Institutions of Higher Education, Hospitals and Other Non-Profit Organizations, and 43 CFR § 12.76 for State and Local Governments.

Our understanding is that there are no specific Disadvantaged Business Enterprise (DBE) requirements where a certified firm is a small business and owned by socially and economically disadvantaged individuals. There are WBE/MBE goals that the ORTC will attempt to meet, if we use funding from the NPS-CCSP grant. We also have the Port of Pittsburgh grant for part of the project, which does not have that federal requirement. However, the ORTC is committed to meeting the goals of the WBE/MBE and feels that the DBE fall into the same category.

5. Is the Department of Conservation and Natural Resources (DCNR) involved in this project, and if so, in what capacity?

DCNR is not involved directly in this initiative. DCNR is a partner in the PA Water Trails Program and as part of their mission is interested in water trail activities statewide.

BUDGET

6. What is the total project funding to ORTC?

\$15,000 is budgeted for both the design work and printing costs. We are asking the consultants to bid the project with and without printing costs.

7. What is the total budget for all consultant services?

\$15,000 is budgeted for both the design work and printing costs. We are asking the consultants to bid the project with and without printing costs.

8. What budget has ORTC set for printing?

\$15,000 is budgeted for both the Design work and Printing costs. We are asking the consultants to bid the project with and without printing costs.

9. What is the project budget for all ORTC services?

The Ohio River Trail Council is a Pennsylvania based non-profit, volunteer-led corporation and will not be reimbursed for its services for this project.

ORTC & ORWT COMMITTEE ASSISTANCE

10. Is your committee able to provide any specific information that would help reduce costs? A big one is reliable directions to access points. Another is write-ups for points of interest.

Yes, the research and descriptions for the points of interest has been accomplished and is available in the updated ORTC PowerPoint (PPT) which will be provided to the selected consultant. The Ohio River Water Trail (ORWT) Committee will draft the text for the document, including directions to access points. The committee wants to work closely with the contractor in planning the schedule and map/brochure content.

11. What specific services will ORTC perform toward this project - such as project management, publicity, meeting organization, committee contacts/coordination, etc.?

The ORTC will assist with all the above along with representatives from the National Park Service Rivers, Trails and Conservation Assistance (NPS-RTCA) Program and PEC who are members of the ORWT committee. The consultant can count on meeting organization, committee coordination, drafting and editing of text, fine-tooth editing of the map/guide from the committee. The committee will work closely with the contractor in planning the schedule and map/brochure content.

12. What is the size of the project committee that the consultant will work with?

There are 16 committee members which are listed on attachment A of the RFP. We expect a core group of 8 will focus on the map/guide component.

13. The list of partners and affiliations was provided in the RFP to review the draft map. How long of a review period should be provided for?

We expect there will be ongoing reviews of the draft map and text and layout, with perhaps 2-3 week total review time. We are flexible and will work with the consultant, but want to have an aesthetic and accurate product that we all can be proud of.

14. Attachment A. Based on the size of the ORWT Committee, does the ORTC have a participation program in mind? Will the entire Committee meet together? Are there a targeted number of meetings for this Committee? Are there subcommittees or do any members or groups within the Committee have specific activities or roles that they are going to perform?

The ORTC does not have a written participation program. The ORWT Committee is large but is divided into subcommittees - Family Paddling Program, History, Land Management, River Management, Financials, and Map & Guide. There is a core group of about eight members that will be actively involved in the Map & Guide project. We expect to schedule monthly meetings.

RIVER RECONNAISSANCE

15. Would any committee members help with shuttle if the consultant wanted to see the river first hand?

Yes, the ORTC will assist with shuttle to support your efforts on the river.

16. Would more than two ORTC representatives be anticipated to attend the boat reconnaissance?

The ORTC will provide as many representatives as needed. We also have a companion project to develop a Family & Youth Paddling Program, so there are ORWT reps that will be paddling the corridor to develop their guiding skills – this activity could coincide with the reconnaissance, but it is not required or necessarily expected. The ORTC would not want to slow down the consultant's work.

17. The project area covers 63 miles of water. Is it anticipated that the contractor will navigate all 63 miles by boat? Please confirm. If so does ORTC have a rough time estimate of how long it will take to navigate the 63 miles including potential delays at dams or should the standard 1 hour per mile be used for cost estimating purposes?

Even though a wealth of information has already been collected by the ORTC, it is advisable for the contractor to view or paddle the corridor by boat. The ORTC goal is to identify all hazards to ensure safety for the public through cautions and warnings. Some of the members of the ORWT Committee have paddled segments, and they will be available to assist in the effort.

We do not know how long it will take to navigate the corridor. There are only three Lock & Dams to navigate: Emsworth, Dashields, and Montgomery.

18. Does the 63-mile water trail length include the lengths of the 12 mile, 3 mile and 2 mile tributaries?

Yes.

19. Assess corridor by boat identifying and verifying existing and potential access points, hazards along the river, and opportunities along the river... Is the consultant responsible for acquiring use of a boat and any other associated equipment and gear?

Yes, this is the consultant's responsibility.

20. Does ORTC have a boat for the consultant to utilize for the river reconnaissance, or do we need to include the costs for a boat in our direct costs? If ORTC has a boat available for this reconnaissance - how many people does it hold? Are the three tributaries all navigable by the same boat used on the Ohio main stem? Or are smaller boats required?

No, the ORTC does not have a motor boat. However, one of the supporting municipalities may be able to assist. Members of the ORWT Committee have canoes/kayaks and gear in an effort to support the consultant. All tributaries should be navigable using a motor boat except Raccoon Creek. Raccoon Creek is the only tributary that may require a kayak or canoe. Raccoon Creek is normally canoeable from March through June. The gauge at Moffet Mill should read 2.2 feet or above. At this level the creek has a Class One rating. Raccoon Creek water levels and stream flow of course are higher in the late spring. Stream flow information is available at <http://water.usgs.gov/waterwatch/>

21. Is the entire stream doable in a sea-kayak? I see on the PPT show that kayaks can lock through. Any impassable (non-portage-able) river-wide dams or other obstacles?

Yes a sea kayak can be used to navigate the Ohio River and its tributaries. No known impassable dams or other obstacles. Some of the ORWT Committee members paddle the Ohio River and tributaries in a small 10' kayak.

22. Please confirm or clarify that all landings, hazards, access points, known points of interest have been located with GPS and quantified – and that the consultant map review and river reconnaissance is to confirm these points and to possibly add new ones.

There is no guarantee that we have identified all points and hazards. Yes, it is desired that the consultant confirm our work, and possibly add new points.

ACCESS SITES & FIELD VERIFICATION, GPS POINTS, AND GIS DATA

23. Is additional field work anticipated for the field verification as referred to in part 2.1.2?

Yes, we anticipate that field work is required to complete this task. However, there should not be a lot of additional field check, since the PPT presentation prepared by the ORTC has identified most or all of the sites. In addition, the ORTC Water Trail committee can assist with field checking.

Given our current funding, please include the field view as a separate part of the bid so that we can evaluate the cost of this item.

24. My experience with waterway trails is to have launch sites/C-K Ports every 3 to 5 miles. I attempt to use public & consenting private sites whenever planning & designing a waterway trail and only construct sites when the distance between sites is >5 miles. In 2.2.3 “key private access points” (provided by client), is the intent to utilize existing public/private launch sites and supplement launch sites if the distance between sites is > 5 miles?

Yes, we will be utilizing existing public launch sites and private sites that allow public use. For the purposes of this project's RFP, we are simply documenting the existing conditions on the river, not trying to plan/design/build new launches.

25. I was part of the “Trail Town Program” for the Great Allegheny Passage”. Is the intent of 2.2.4 & 2.2.5 to include the economic stimulus for a similar ORTC Waterway Trail Program?

Yes, this also ties into the planned development of land trails along the Ohio River and its tributaries. We would like to highlight the communities along the route, and identify some of the nearby businesses that cater to water trail users.

26. Acquire additional GPS points as needed. Does ORTC have an estimate of how many additional points may need to be acquired?

The estimate is 5 to 10.

27. ORTC has compiled 529 PowerPoint slides with much of this information (see Attachment C). What format will the data, contained in the 529 PowerPoint slides, be provided?

The majority of the data will be provided as a PowerPoint Presentation. In addition, a list of access sites and points of interest with lat/long, along with drafted text for the map/guide will be delivered in Microsoft Word document format.

28. Will the Key private access points be provided as a GIS layer containing supplemental attributes or just a list of lat/long points?

The ORTC will provide a list of lat/long points that we have collected, some of which are from Google Earth. The ORTC does not currently have GIS information for the access points. All consultants should refer to the PA Fish and Boat Commission web site where there is mapping information on the web site listing access points. We can obtain GIS information from the PA Fish and Boat Commission for the existing sites that are shown as a base layer and the consultant will need to add additional sites as identified or for sites that are missing from this data layer.

29. ORTC will provide lat/long of most all points of interest and brochure text. Will the points be provided as a GIS layer with attributes or as a list of lat/longs with associated point of interest name?

The ORTC will provide a list of lat/long with associated point of interest name.

30. Will lat/long data be provided for the points referenced in the PowerPoint slides?

Yes.

31. Approximately how many access points will be provided?

An approximate number of access points are available in the provided PPT slides 211-437.

Dashields Pool: 2 Planned (P) + 10 Exist (E) = 12.

Montgomery Pool: 3 Planned (P) + 7 Exist (E) = 10.

Beaver River: 17 Exist (E).

Raccoon Creek (lower 2 miles): 2.

New Cumberland Pool: in PA 2 Exist (E), in OH/WV 5 Exist (E).

Little Beaver Creek: 3 Exist (E).

There is also the Emsworth Pool which the ORTC has not yet collected data. The Three Rivers Water Trail guide covers this section, and has identified five access sites, all on River Right; however additional field check is needed to determine updates.

In total, the ORTC has gathered preliminary information on about 56 Existing + Planned access sites.

32. Does the committee have any readily available GIS data specific to the water trail area such as land trails, shipping lane, buoys, river miles, public islands, important bird areas, etc.?

There is existing GIS data for the Ohio River South Shore Trail and North Shore Trail. We will have to check with the US Army Corps of Engineers and US Fish & Wildlife Service for any GIS files that they might have. The ORWT Committee will work closely with the consultant to assist. PEC has compiled GIS base mapping / layers / shape files for the 46 counties in the 4-state area of PA-WV-OH-MD, called "Power of 32 Trail Map" and these ArcGIS project files can be made available for this project.

33. We understand the list of GIS layers in Attachment B will be collected from secondary sources? Please confirm. What counties and other partners have committed GIS data toward this project?

Yes. There are several data sources that are available for this map including Pennsylvania Spatial Data Access (PASDA) and the PA Fish & Boat Commission.

In West Virginia (WV), much of this information can be freely downloaded from the WV GIS Technical Center at WVU at wvgis.wvu.edu/.

In Ohio, the data is available from the Ohio Geographically Referenced Information Program (OGRIP) at <http://ogrip.oit.ohio.gov/ServicesData/OhioMetadataExplorer.aspx>. Ohio also has some data with ODNR at <http://ohiodnr.com/gims/category/tabid/10528/Default.aspx>.

PEC has compiled GIS base mapping / layers / shape files for the 46 counties in the 4-state area of PA-WV-OH-MD, called "Power of 32 Trail Map" and these ArcGIS project files can be made available for this project.

ORTC will acquire the GIS data for the proposed Ohio River South Shore Trail and the Ohio River North Shore Trail.

34. Will the consultant or the ORTC be responsible for collecting existing GIS base maps, layers and information?

The Consultant is ultimately responsible for collecting existing GIS data.

BIDDING RATES

35. What standard for overhead rates should be used? Can fully loaded hourly rates be provided for as a contract alternative?

We do not know.

36. If overhead rates must be used that are certified by a specific agency, what rules apply and what is the allowable profit percentage?

We do not know.

ADDITIONAL MAPPING POINTS

37. Is there a regional or county emergency management plan with a universal numbering system that needs to be incorporated into the map?

We do not know.

38. Are there river mile markers visible on the river?

The only existing river mile markers are the ones placed by the Friends of the Riverfront which are noted on the Three Rivers Water Trail map.

ISLANDS

39. Are there any public islands? An island has to be deeded, warranted and patented in order to be private. If not, then it usually is state-owned and managed by the Bureau of Forestry which allows primitive 'Leave No Trace' camping. DCNR sent a couple of interns out to certain areas researching and identifying public islands a few years back. Was this stretch included?

There are two islands that are included in the Ohio River Islands National Wildlife Refuge. There are other islands, but we don't know the ownership status of them. Georgetown Island and Brunot's Island were used by Lewis & Clark Expedition. We would like to explore access to these islands, as well as promote the Expedition's history.

PUBLIC MEETINGS

40. Have there been or will there be any public meetings pertaining to the water trail?

There have been no public meetings to date regarding the water trail, however there have been numerous public meetings regarding the Ohio River Land Trails and the EPA Brownfield Study. The ORTC anticipates scheduling a public meeting for a review of draft map.

LOGO

41. For aspects of the project such as development of the logo, was the intention to work with a marketing firm (sub) to develop this or is this something they already know what they want and they just want to put into the electronic format that they want for printing?

The ORTC does require some design assistance with developing a logo. The PA Water Trails Program has a standard logo for water trails where the top half is customized and available in an EPS format. The bottom half needs to be customized to this water trail. Please refer to the other water trail map and guides that are available on the PA Fish and Boat Commission's web site and the ORTC PowerPoint (PPT) to see samples of other water trail logos. With respect to the use of a marketing firm that depends on the capacity of the responding consultant.

WEBSITE

42. Website files of the map/guide (i.e. PDF format), segmented into 8 ½" X 11" pages for printing by the general public. Is there any possibility (and interest) to expand the website publication to include interactive on-line mapping on the website in addition to the downloadable PDF's?

Yes, we are interested. However, we do not believe we have the funding at this time to include this feature in the scope of the RFP. The primary goal of course is to provide a product that the public can easily download, save, and print.

43. Will the consultant be providing separate information for a web page as in the case of the Middle Allegheny River Water Trail Guide (fishandboat.com/watertrails/trailindex)?

Yes, there will be a hard copy version, and a web page version of the identical material.

MAP/GUIDE DETAILS

44. Communicating trail information in easy to read & understand trail maps is important for trail users/customers. Is the intent of 2.3.4 to have an overall small scale map on the top page with trail segments and supplemental spurs such as Little Beaver Creek, Beaver River, and Raccoon Creek on subsequent pages? Would another map (highway type) be developed to meet PF&BC criteria so the trail could be included in the PF&BC system? Would other exploratory spurs be considered such as Chartiers Creek?

This RFP is concerned primarily with the development of a water trail map and guide along the main stem of the Ohio River and the Beaver River to the first dam. However, we also included portions of Raccoon Creek and the Little Beaver Creek which may be able to fit on the top page as part of the main map, or as an inset map, depending on the layout. We intend there to be just a front/back of the map/brochure, as is

typical with PFBC Water Trail Maps. The 8.5 x 11" maps can be developed in whatever manner that makes the most sense by the consultant and the ORWT Committee. In the future, we do plan to expand the water trail mapping for all of the tributaries mentioned, but that will require additional funding.

We do not understand what you mean by a "highway type" map. We need a map that is created with GIS software for easy updating, and then graphically enhanced to fit into the suite of PFBC maps/guides. We are planning to apply for PA Water Trail designation so that the Ohio River Water Trail will be a part of the PA Water Trails System. We are also planning on applying for National Water Trail System designation.

45. Is one map and guide in stone, or would you consider breaking it into at least two sections? About 20-25 miles per map seemed to be a good fit.

The ORTC is flexible with respect to the map design. However, the Upper Monongahela River Water Trail map/guide covers 65 miles on one map, thereby cutting printing costs in half.

46. We understand the map/guide will be segmented into 8 1/2 X 11 printable format; does ORTC want the map/guide text converted to 8 1/2 X 11 printable format or just a text document?

We prefer a printable format. To clarify, the text should be prepared to be clear and legible, possibly maintaining graphics/photos and logical page breaks, and able to print onto 8-1/2 x 11" paper. It could be a text document, converted to PDF file. ORTC would like the source file (i.e. MS Word), and the PDF file as a deliverable.

47. Is there an assumption as to the number of design or "folds" for the map?

The ORTC will use the standard size that PA Fish & Boat Commission uses for their map/guides. For example, the Upper Monongahela River Water Trail guide is 21-3/4" x 16-1/2", and has 4 major folds making the final folded size 8-1/4" x 3-5/8". We do not know if PFBC considers this a firm size, or if they are flexible.

48. In reference to the 8.5" x 11" segmented map, will this be multiple pages to a certain scale (i.e. 100ft or 50ft) for review, or a single page of the entire map shrunk down for public distribution/discussion?

The task will probably require several maps for public distribution that can be printed at a printable scale not simply shrinking down the entire map to an 8 1/2 x 11 format. The map/brochure contents should be divided into easily printable and clearly readable segments by the user. You can see sample concepts at: <http://fishandboat.com/watertrails/alleg/trailmap.htm> > or http://fishandboat.com/watertrails/yough/yough_north_map.pdf.

49. Does ORTC expect the final map product to be similar in content and format to the Three Rivers Water Trail Map and Guide (fishandboat.com/watertrails/trailindex)?

This is a good option, but the ORTC is flexible. Since the two water trails overlap, it would make better sense to the trail user if the two Map/Guides use similar format, symbols, etc. We might imagine long-distance paddlers using both maps. Also, Three Rivers Water Trail includes the uppermost 12 miles of the Ohio River, so the maps will be a bit duplicative or overlapping.

50. The specifications for the printing of the maps for the ORTC proposal are in need of clarification. First, the size given was 16.50" x 21.75" and is requiring folding. If quarter folded the final size is 8.25" x 10.875". Your books final size is 8.5 x 11". Does this piece bind in the final piece or is it free floating and inserting to a pocket. If so, the size is fine. If it spiral binds, there needs to be a portion that extends beyond the 8.25". Second, how does it fold specifically?

The final product is not a book. It is a folded poster/brochure that includes a map on one side, and text/graphics on the other. The final folded size should be something like 8-1/4" x 3-5/8".

DELIVERABLES

51. We understand the deliverables will include a Geodatabase containing all of the GIS layers, graphic design files of the map/guide, website files of the map/guide segmented into 8 1/2" X 11", and logo design provided in JPG and EPS format. Please confirm.

Yes. But, we would also like the bids to be given with and without the Printing costs, so 10-20K brochures might be included as a Deliverable. See "2 Scope, 5) Optional: Printed Map/Guide from professional print shop, using agreed on specifications." Also see "2.4 Optional: Publication of Map/Guide."

52. GIS files (i.e. shape files) of base mapping, for future map updates. Are the deliverables for future map updates to include the GIS map files themselves i.e. ArcMap MXD and is there a preferred software version?

Yes, the ORTC will take ownership of the source files, base map files, GIS map files, shape files, and ArcMap MXD. We do not have a preferred software version, but would like to see the most recent version being used.

53. Graphic design files (i.e. EPS files) of the map/guide ready to take to the printer. Are the deliverables for graphic design files to include the design files themselves i.e. Adobe InDesign INDD and is there a preferred software version?

Yes, the ORTC will take ownership of the original files, such as INDD. We do not have a preferred software version, but would like to see the most recent version being used.